Personal Fall Arrest System Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1926.502)

For supervisors checking fall protection on a construction site before and during work at height.

OSHA 29 CFR 1926.502

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. When an item fails, remove the defective component from service, and don't let work that needs that protection start until it is corrected.
3. The manufacturer's instructions and your site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1926.502: Fall protection systems criteria and practices (Part 1926 Subpart M: Fall Protection) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1926-502-fall-protection-systems-criteria-practices

SECTION A | Harness, lanyards and lifelines

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Pre-use check Ref. 1926.502(d)(21)	Harness, lanyard, lifeline and connectors checked before this use; no wear, damage or other deterioration found	☐	☐	☐	
2	Defective parts Ref. 1926.502(d)(21)	Any worn, damaged or deteriorated component removed from service	☐	☐	☐	
3	Harness, not body belt, for fall arrest Ref. 1926.502(d)	Every worker on a personal fall arrest system wears a body harness; no body belt is part of the arrest system	☐	☐	☐	
4	Harness attachment point Ref. 1926.502(d)(17)	Lanyard or lifeline connected at the center of the back near shoulder level, or above the head	☐	☐	☐	
5	Equipment that has arrested a fall Ref. 1926.502(d)(19)	No impact-loaded harness, lanyard or connector in use unless a competent person inspected it and found it undamaged and suitable for reuse	☐	☐	☐	
6	Lifeline protection Ref. 1926.502(d)(11)	Lifelines run clear of sharp edges or are protected; no cuts or abrasion on the line	☐	☐	☐	
7	One worker per vertical lifeline Ref. 1926.502(d)(10)(i)	Each worker on a separate vertical lifeline, unless every elevator shaft condition in 1926.502(d)(10)(ii) is met	☐	☐	☐	
8	Rope and webbing material Ref. 1926.502(d)(14)	Rope and webbing in lanyards, lifelines and harness strength straps are synthetic fiber	☐	☐	☐	
9	No hoisting with fall gear Ref. 1926.502(d)(18)	Harnesses, lanyards and components not used to lift or lower materials	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Connectors and snaphooks

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
10	Locking snaphooks Ref. 1926.502(d)(5)	Every snaphook in use is a locking type	☐	☐	☐	
11	Snaphook connections Ref. 1926.502(d)(6)	No snaphook clipped directly to webbing, rope or wire rope, to another snaphook, to a D-ring already holding another connector, to a horizontal lifeline, or to an object that could open the keeper, unless the locking hook is designed for that connection	☐	☐	☐	
12	Connector material Ref. 1926.502(d)(1)	Connectors are drop forged, pressed or formed steel, or an equivalent material	☐	☐	☐	
13	Connector finish Ref. 1926.502(d)(2)	Corrosion-resistant finish; no rough surfaces or sharp edges that could damage webbing or other parts	☐	☐	☐	
14	D-ring and snaphook rating Ref. 1926.502(d)(3)	Manufacturer data shows a rated tensile strength of 5,000 pounds or more	☐	☐	☐	
15	Lanyard and vertical lifeline rating Ref. 1926.502(d)(9)	Label or manufacturer data shows breaking strength of 5,000 pounds or more	☐	☐	☐	
16	Self-retracting devices limiting free fall to 2 feet Ref. 1926.502(d)(12)	Devices that limit free fall to 2 feet or less are rated to sustain 3,000 pounds or more with the line fully extended	☐	☐	☐	
17	Other self-retracting devices and energy-absorbing lanyards Ref. 1926.502(d)(13)	Self-retracting devices that don't limit free fall to 2 feet or less, ripstitch lanyards, and tearing and deforming lanyards are rated to sustain 5,000 pounds or more with the line fully extended	☐	☐	☐	
18	Suspended scaffold lifeline devices Ref. 1926.502(d)(7)	Where a horizontal lifeline can become vertical, the connecting device locks in both directions	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Anchorage, rigging and rescue

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
19	Protection in place before work Ref. 1926.502(a)(2)	Required fall protection installed before the worker starts the task that exposes them to the fall	☐	☐	☐	
20	Anchorage Ref. 1926.502(d)(15)	Anchor independent of any platform support or suspension anchor and rated for 5,000 pounds per worker attached, or engineered under qualified-person supervision as 1926.502(d)(15)(i) and (ii) set out	☐	☐	☐	
21	Free fall and clearance Ref. 1926.502(d)(16)(iii)	Anchor height and lanyard length keep free fall to 6 feet or less, and the worker cannot contact any lower level during an arrest	☐	☐	☐	
22	Horizontal lifelines Ref. 1926.502(d)(8)	Lifeline designed, installed and used under a qualified person's supervision, as part of a complete personal fall arrest system that keeps a safety factor of at least two	☐	☐	☐	
23	No tie-off to guardrails or hoists Ref. 1926.502(d)(23)	No lanyard or lifeline attached to a guardrail; none attached to a hoist unless another subpart allows it	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION C | Anchorage, rigging and rescue

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
24	Hoist area rigging Ref. 1926.502(d)(24)	At hoist areas the system lets the worker reach the edge of the walking/working surface and no farther	☐	☐	☐	
25	Rescue Ref. 1926.502(d)(20)	Prompt rescue arrangements in place for a fallen worker, or workers able to rescue themselves	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Guardrails

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
26	Top rail height Ref. 1926.502(b)(1)	Top edge measures 42 inches, plus or minus 3 inches, from the deck (raised by stilt height where stilts are used)	☐	☐	☐	
27	Midrails or equivalent Ref. 1926.502(b)(2)	Midrail, screen, mesh or intermediate members present wherever there is no wall or parapet at least 21 inches high	☐	☐	☐	
28	Midrail position Ref. 1926.502(b)(2)(i)	Midrail halfway between the top edge and the walking/working level	☐	☐	☐	
29	Openings Ref. 1926.502(b)(2)(iv)	No opening in the guardrail system more than 19 inches wide	☐	☐	☐	
30	No banding Ref. 1926.502(b)(8)	No steel or plastic banding used as a top rail or midrail	☐	☐	☐	
31	Rail size Ref. 1926.502(b)(9)	Top rails and midrails at least one-quarter inch nominal diameter or thickness	☐	☐	☐	
32	Wire rope flagging Ref. 1926.502(b)(9)	Wire rope top rails flagged with high-visibility material at no more than 6-foot intervals	☐	☐	☐	
33	Rail surfaces Ref. 1926.502(b)(6)	No splinters, burrs or points that could puncture or cut a worker or snag clothing	☐	☐	☐	
34	Guardrails at holes Ref. 1926.502(b)(11)	Guardrail on every unprotected side or edge of the hole	☐	☐	☐	
35	Hoisting access opening Ref. 1926.502(b)(10)	Chain, gate or removable section across the access opening whenever hoisting is not taking place	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Hole covers and safety nets

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
36	Cover secured Ref. 1926.502(i)(3)	Cover fixed in place so wind, equipment or workers cannot shift it	☐	☐	☐	
37	Cover marked Ref. 1926.502(i)(4)	Cover color coded or marked HOLE or COVER (cast iron manhole covers and steel street grates excepted)	☐	☐	☐	
38	Cover strength Ref. 1926.502(i)(2)	Cover supports at least twice the weight of workers, equipment and materials that may be on it at one time	☐	☐	☐	
39	Roadway and aisle covers Ref. 1926.502(i)(1)	Cover supports at least twice the maximum axle load of the largest vehicle expected to cross	☐	☐	☐	
40	Net position Ref. 1926.502(c)(1)	Net as close as practicable below the work surface and no more than 30 feet below it	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION E | Hole covers and safety nets

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
41	Net inspection Ref. 1926.502(c)(5)	Net inspected within the last week and after any event that could affect it; no wear, damage or deterioration	☐	☐	☐	
42	Net drop test Ref. 1926.502(c)(4)(i)	Drop test done after installation and before use, after relocation or major repair, and within 6 months if left in one place	☐	☐	☐	
43	Net certification record Ref. 1926.502(c)(4)(ii)	Where drop-testing is unreasonable, the latest signed certification record for this net and installation is at the jobsite	☐	☐	☐	
44	Debris in net Ref. 1926.502(c)(6)	No materials, scrap, equipment or tools left in the net; anything that fell in cleared before the next shift	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME